

► H4 MARINE TIMEKEEPER

Date 1759

Origin England

Material Steel, glass, silver

The H4 watch, made by John Jefferys and based on John Harrison's design, lost just 5.1 seconds in the course of a two-month voyage from England to Jamaica, from 18 November 1761 to 19 January 1762.



Silver case



Calibrated rule

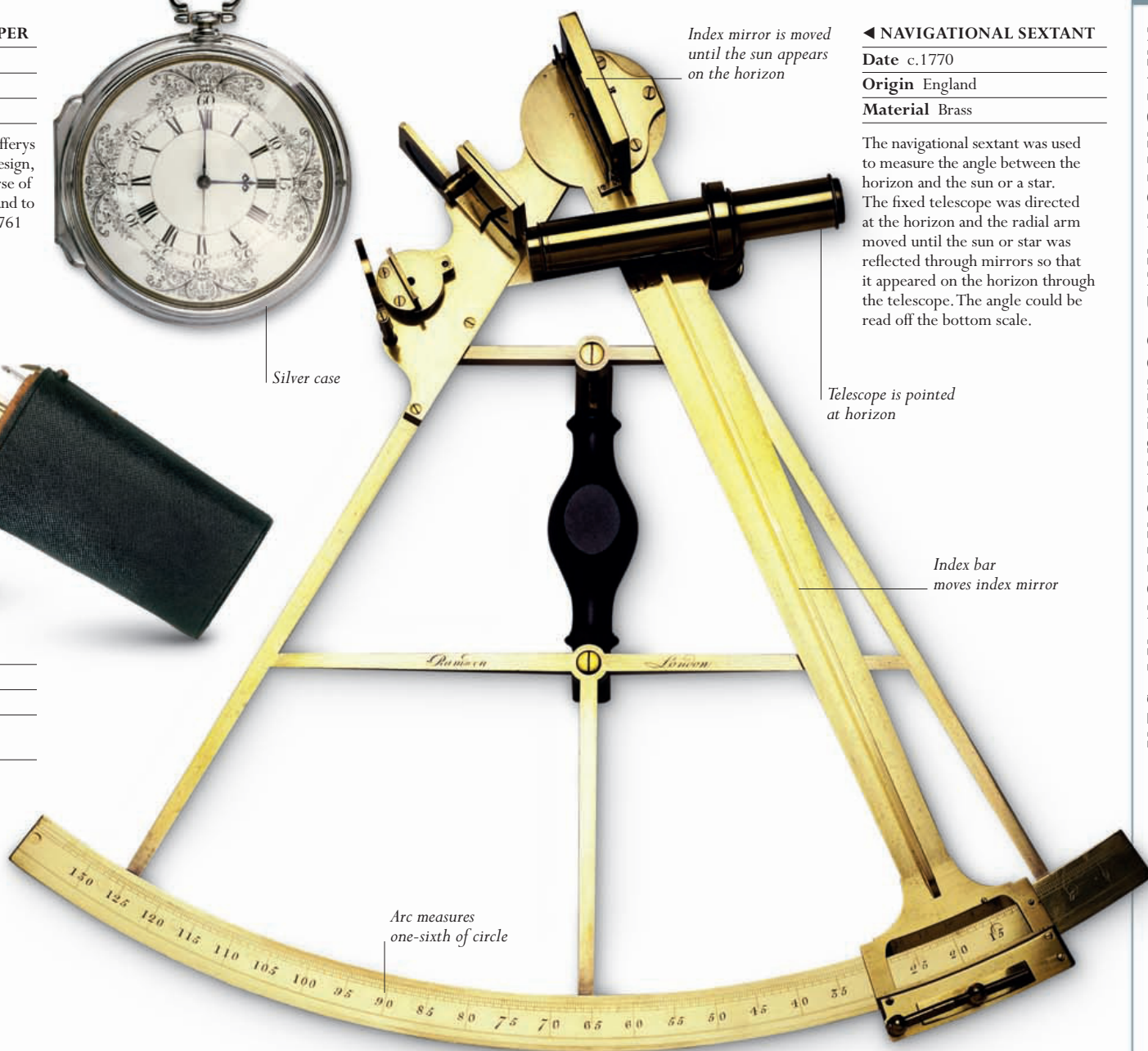
▲ DRAWING TOOLS

Date c.1780

Origin England

Material Brass, wood, leather pouch

Sets of drawing and measuring tools were used by navigators to plot their course and draw marine charts. The tools are contained in a pouch that could be closed.



Arc measures one-sixth of circle

Index mirror is moved until the sun appears on the horizon

◀ NAVIGATIONAL SEXTANT

Date c.1770

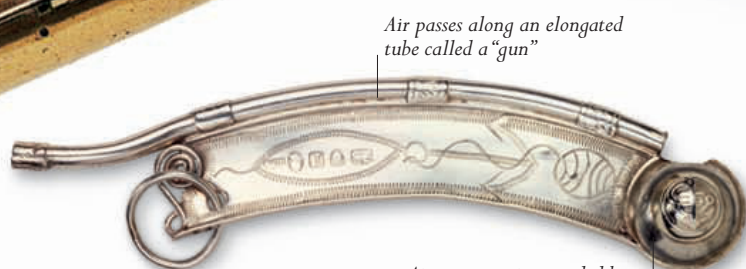
Origin England

Material Brass

The navigational sextant was used to measure the angle between the horizon and the sun or a star. The fixed telescope was directed at the horizon and the radial arm moved until the sun or star was reflected through mirrors so that it appeared on the horizon through the telescope. The angle could be read off the bottom scale.

Telescope is pointed at horizon

Index bar moves index mirror



Air passes along an elongated tube called a "gun"

Air resonates in rounded buoy

▲ BOATSWAIN'S CALL

Date 1792

Origin England

Material Silver

The boatswain's call was a pipe used to convey orders aboard ship. Its shrill whistle could be heard above the sound of wind and waves. A finger was held over the hole to vary the tone – different combinations of tone and length of note signalled different orders.

► BRITISH NAVAL SIGNAL FLAGS

Date 1800

Origin England

Material Linen

Signal flags were used by most navies for communication at sea, but one of the first efficient, codified systems was developed by British Admiral Sir Home Popham in 1800. His system of numerary flags preceded the International Code of Signals, which was adopted worldwide in 1889.



NUMERIC 1



NUMERIC 2



NUMERIC 4



NUMERIC 9